Irinotecan · every three weeks

Irinotecan on Day 1 every 21 days while beneficial and tolerable. There is no home chemotherapy pump. Blood counts are checked weekly, including between infusion visits.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Eyes

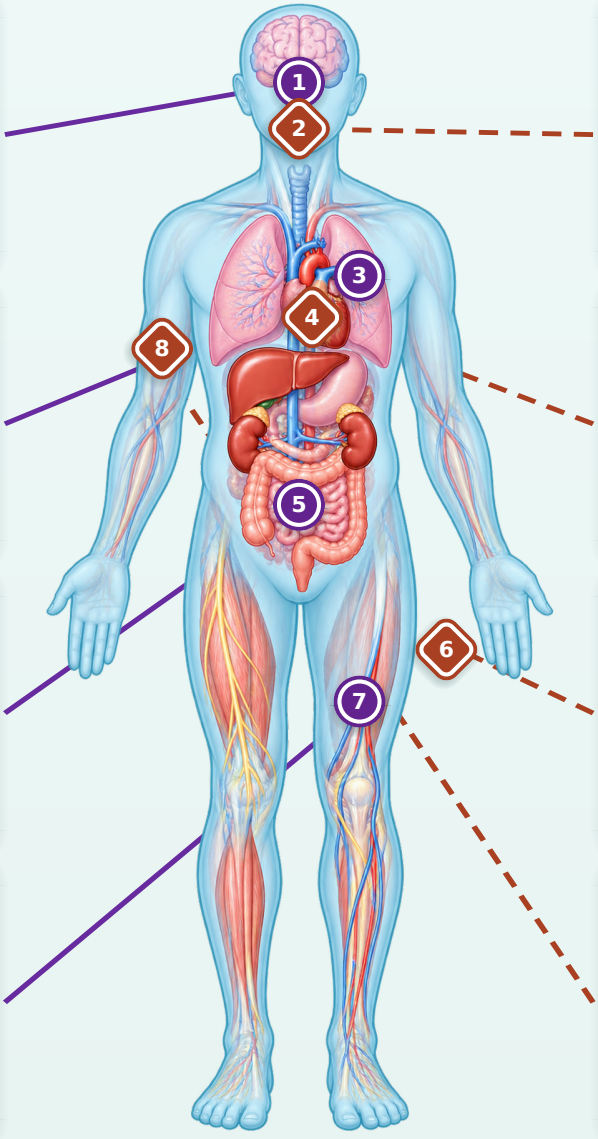
Treatment

Eye pain or new visual change needs prompt advice.

2 Mouth / swallowing

Treatment

Pain or ulcers affecting eating or drinking need advice.



3 Breathing / reaction

Treatment

New breathing difficulty requires prompt assessment.

4 Chest

Treatment

New chest pain needs urgent assessment.

5 Bowel

Irinotecan

Diarrhoea, increased stoma output or dehydration: call early.

6 Skin / nails

Irinotecan

Report troublesome skin changes or painful hands/feet.

7 Blood / infection

Treatment

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

8 Infusion access

Treatment delivery

Pain, swelling, leakage or a loose connection needs immediate advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Irinotecan

- Early cramps, sweating and diarrhoea
- Delayed diarrhoea and dehydration
- Low blood counts / serious infection
- Nausea, mouth soreness and fatigue
- Hair thinning or loss
- Rare serious lung or allergic reactions

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Before treatment

The team checks blood counts, kidney/liver function, symptoms, allergies and medicines. Weekly blood counts are part of this irinotecan plan.

Bowel symptoms and fluids

Irinotecan can cause early cramps/sweating during infusion and delayed diarrhoea after 24 hours. You need separate instructions for each. Follow your written rescue plan. Fever, blood, severe pain, reduced urine or inability to drink needs urgent advice.

Plan the visit

Allow for blood tests, review, pharmacy preparation, infusion and observation. A port is not automatically required; ask which access is suitable.

Comfort and daily life

Use prescribed anti-sickness medicines, pace activities and ask for nutritional, emotional or practical support.

The whole treatment plan

Ask how and when the team will assess benefit, which blood tests continue during a pause, and what happens after the final dose. Weekly blood counts remain part of the irinotecan plan between visits.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00213/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.